Impartial Analysis – Los Altos School District

School Facilities Bond Measure EE

Start → California law permits school districts to issue bonds with the approval of 55% of district voters. Such bonds may be used only for construction, reconstruction, rehabilitation, or replacement of school facilities, including furnishing and equipping those facilities, or the acquisition or lease of real property for school facilities. 48

The Board of Trustees (Board) of the Los Altos School District (District) has placed on the ballot a Measure authorizing the issuance and sale of up to $350,000,000 in such bonds for the purposes of constructing, renovating, and updating school facilities. 41

As identified in the Measure, the types of projects may include but are not limited to: 16

- Constructing and updating elementary and junior high school classrooms, labs, restrooms, multi-purpose rooms, kitchen and food preparation areas, and other facilities; 21
- Repairing or replacing leaky roofs and windows; 7
- Repairing or replacing heating, ventilation, air-conditioning, plumbing, electrical, sewer, and water systems; 12
- Making health, safety, and security improvements; 6
- Performing disability-access upgrades; 4
- Replacing or removing temporary portable buildings; 6
- Constructing a new school and related facilities; 7
- Constructing, improving, or upgrading paved surfaces, technology infrastructure, and electrical systems and wiring; 13
- Constructing recreation facilities; and 4
- Installing or improving physical education and playground facilities and other outdoor spaces. 12

Project costs may include architectural, engineering, legal, and similar planning costs, as well as staff training expenses. As state law requires, the Measure prohibits bond proceeds from being used for teacher or administrator salaries or other school operating expenses. 39

These general obligation bonds will be payable from ad valorem taxes levied on taxable real property within the District. The Measure states that the best estimate of the average annual tax rate to be levied to repay the proposed bonds is $30 per $100,000 of assessed value, and that the final fiscal year in which the tax is anticipated to be collected will be 2060-2061. The Measure states that the best estimate of the total debt service during the life of the bond, including principal and interest, is $730,800,000. 89

State law requires the District to take certain steps to account for the bond proceeds. Accordingly, the District has listed in the Measure the specific projects to be funded, including a certification that, in developing the list, the Board evaluated safety, class size reduction, and information technology needs. Additionally, the District will direct the proceeds be deposited into a special account, appoint an independent citizens' oversight committee, conduct annual independent performance and financial audits, and prepare annual reports on funds collected and expended and the status of any funded project. 90

A "yes" vote is a vote to authorize the issuance and sale of up to $350,000,000 of general obligation bonds to fund school facilities projects as described in the Measure. 30

A "no" vote is a vote not to authorize the issuance and sale of the bonds. ← stop 16

Tony LoPresti
County Counsel

WC: 461

By:

[redacted]

Jamila Benkato
Deputy County Counsel